Nissan Pulsar (Australia) Specification & Service Reference - Page 1/2

AUSTRALIAN AUTOMOTIVE ARCHIVE - TECHNICAL & SPECIFICATION DOSSIER

Make: Nissan | Model: Pulsar | Australian Market Years: 1980-2017
Vehicle Type: Hatchback / Sedan | Segment: Small Car / Hot Hatch | Locally Built: Yes
Assembly Plants (AU): Clayton, Victoria (Nissan Motor Manufacturing Australia)

1. MODEL OVERVIEW & AUSTRALIAN MARKET NOTES

The Nissan Pulsar is one of Australia's most historic small-car badges. Manufactured locally at Nissan's Clayton plant in Victoria through the 1980s and early 1990s, the Pulsar sired genuine Australian performance legends, from the local 1980s Pulsar Turbo ET to the iconic N14/N15 Pulsar SSS with its high-revving 2.0-litre SR20DE engine and the rally-homologated N14 GTI-R.

First sold in 1980, the Clayton-built N12 series gave Australia its first mass-market factory turbocharged hatchback: the 1984 Pulsar Turbo ET. The Clayton plant also built the N12 and N13 Pulsar for Holden as the Astra under the Button Car Plan. Following local factory closure in 1992, fully imported Japanese N14 and N15 Pulsar SSS hatchbacks became beloved Aussie performance benchmarks. The badge returned with the B17/C12 series in 2013, highlighted by the 140kW DIG-Turbo SSS hatch.

SERIES / GENERATION: N10/N12 (Pulsar 1st & 2nd Gen (inc. Turbo ET)) [1980-1987]

Body Styles: 3-door Hatch, 5-door Hatch, 4-door Sedan | ANCAP: Untested
Clayton-built N12 launched Australia's first affordable hot hatch in 1984: the Pulsar Turbo ET with a 77kW turbocharged 1.5L E15ET engine, also badge-engineered as the Holden Astra LB/LC.

Engines Offered in Australia:

- E15ET: 1.5L (1488cc) Inline-44 (Turbocharged (Garrett T2), Petrol) | 77.0 kW / 140.0 Nm

Australian Badges / Trims:

- Turbo ET: Drivetrain=FWD, Trans=5-speed manual, AUD $11990-$13990, Fuel=8.5L/100km

Factory Configurations:

* Pulsar Turbo ET Hatch | 3-door Hatch | E15ET | 5-speed manual | FWD | 77.0kW/140.0Nm

SERIES / GENERATION: N13 (Pulsar 3rd Generation (Clayton-built)) [1987-1991]

Body Styles: 5-door Hatch, 4-door Sedan (Vector) | ANCAP: Untested
Clayton-built N13 series featuring Holden-supplied Family II 1.6L and 1.8L engines under the UAA joint venture. Introduced the Vector luxury sedan and sporting SSS hatch.

Engines Offered in Australia:

- 20LE: 1.8L (1796cc) Inline-44 (Naturally Aspirated, Unleaded Petrol) | 79.0 kW / 151.0 Nm

Australian Badges / Trims:

- Vector / SSS: Drivetrain=FWD, Trans=5-speed manual, 4-speed automatic, AUD $17990-$23500, Fuel=8.2L/1

Factory Configurations:

* Pulsar SSS 1.8 Hatch | 5-door Hatch | 20LE | 5-speed manual | FWD | 79.0kW/151.0Nm

SERIES / GENERATION: N14 (Pulsar 4th Gen (SSS & GTI-R)) [1991-1995]

Body Styles: 3-door Hatch, 5-door Hatch, 4-door Sedan | ANCAP: Untested
Introduced the redtop SR20DE 2.0L engine to the Pulsar SSS hatch, alongside the homologation tiptan Pulsar GTI-R (SR20DET 169kW with ATTESA AWD).

Engines Offered in Australia:

- SR20DE-N14: 2.0L (1998cc) Inline-44 (Naturally Aspirated, Petrol) | 105.0 kW / 179.0 Nm

- SR20DET-GTIR: 2.0L (1998cc) Inline-44 (Turbocharged Intercooled (Garrett T28), Premium Unleaded Petro

Australian Badges / Trims:

- SSS Hatch: Drivetrain=FWD with viscous LSD, Trans=5-speed manual, 4-speed automatic, AUD $24990-$2799
- GTI-R: Drivetrain=ATTESA Full-Time AWD, Trans=5-speed manual, AUD $44990-$44990, Fuel=10.8L/100km

Factory Configurations:

* Pulsar SSS Hatch Manual | 5-door Hatch | SR20DE-N14 | 5-speed manual | FWD | 105.0kW/179.0Nm

SERIES / GENERATION: N15 (Pulsar 5th Gen (SR20DE SSS)) [1995-2000]

Body Styles: 3-door Hatch, 5-door Hatch, 4-door Sedan | ANCAP: 3 stars

The definitive Australian hot hatch of the late 1990s. Powered by the high-revving 105kW 2.0L S
R20DE engine with multi-link beam rear suspension and viscous LSD.

Engines Offered in Australia:

- SR20DE-N15: 2.0L (1998cc) Inline-44 (Naturally Aspirated, Petrol) | 105.0 kW / 179.0 Nm

Australian Badges / Trims:

- SSS Hatch: Drivetrain=FWD with viscous LSD, Trans=5-speed manual, 4-speed automatic, AUD $26990-$2999

Factory Configurations:

* Pulsar SSS N15 Manual | 5-door Hatch | SR20DE-N15 | 5-speed manual | FWD | 105.0kW/179.0Nm

SERIES / GENERATION: N16 (Pulsar 6th Generation) [2000-2006]

Body Styles: 5-door Hatch, 4-door Sedan | ANCAP: 4 stars

Conservative family commuter offering 1.8L QG18DE engine, standard dual airbags, and spacious s
edan and hatch packaging.

Engines Offered in Australia:

- QG18DE: 1.8L (1769cc) Inline-44 (Naturally Aspirated, Petrol) | 92.0 kW / 161.0 Nm

Australian Badges / Trims:

- ST / Q: Drivetrain=FWD, Trans=5-speed manual, 4-speed automatic, AUD $19990-$24990, Fuel=7.8L/100km

Factory Configurations:

* Pulsar Q 1.8 Hatch | 5-door Hatch | QG18DE | 5-speed manual | FWD | 92.0kW/161.0Nm

SERIES / GENERATION: B17/C12 (Pulsar 7th Gen (inc. DIG-Turbo SSS)) [2013-2017]

Body Styles: 4-door Sedan (B17), 5-door Hatch (C12) | ANCAP: 5 stars

Revival of the Pulsar name in Australia. B17 sedan offered class-leading rear legroom, while C1
2 SSS hatch revived the hero badge with a 140kW 1.6L DIG-Turbo engine.

Engines Offered in Australia:

- MR16DDT: 1.6L (1618cc) Inline-44 (Turbocharged Intercooled, Premium Unleaded Petrol) | 140.0 kW / 240

Australian Badges / Trims:

- SSS Hatch: Drivetrain=FWD, Trans=6-speed manual, Xtronic CVT, AUD $26990-$29990, Fuel=7.7L/100km

Factory Configurations:

* Pulsar SSS Turbo Manual | 5-door Hatch | MR16DDT | 6-speed manual | FWD | 140.0kW/240.0Nm